

Procurely Flow — Revised Strategy & Market Reality Check

A revision of the original proposal, checked against current market, regulatory and FX data as of August 2026.

Bottom line, unchanged from the original: build Procurely Flow — a procurement operating system for request, approval, sourcing, purchasing and tracking — starting with construction and property development. The core thesis is sound. This revision corrects several things that were wrong, missing, or optimistically framed in the first draft.

What changed in this revision

- Replaced the global business-spend-management figure with the actual Middle East & Africa procurement-software slice — the global number overstated the near-term opportunity
- Named the real competitors already selling into Nigeria (SeamlessProcure, Fraxion, Duplo) instead of comparing only against generic software categories
- Reframed e-invoicing from "a later module" to a near-term compliance deadline that's already live for the target customer segment, and a possible acquisition wedge
- Added guidance on currency exposure and how B2B subscriptions actually get collected in Nigeria
- Added a section on the internal adoption resistance procurement-digitization projects commonly face
- Split the MVP into two build phases so the 8-12 week pilot matches what's actually shippable
- Added multi-currency line items and NDPA/NDPC data-handling as day-one considerations
- Moved WhatsApp approval support from "eventually" into phase one

Why this is the right product

Procurely already has three advantages most software startups spend years trying to acquire:

- You are already handling real procurement transactions.
- Edala gives you a live property-development use case — and a substantial one. Edala Development currently manages a multi-billion-naira portfolio of residential, hospitality and commercial projects across Lagos and Oyo State, which is a legitimate proxy for the ₦20m-₦500m/month segment this plan targets.
- Procurely already has supplier relationships, pricing information and operational knowledge.

That means you would not be inventing software based on assumptions. You would turn Procurely's existing procurement process into a product — a genuinely rare starting position.

Market opportunity — sized correctly

The category is real and it's fundable in this region. But anchor the opportunity on the right number.

The \$26 billion figure for global business-spend-management software is accurate as a global figure, but it says almost nothing about what's addressable from Lagos in the next three years. Procurement software specifically — a narrower, more comparable category than the broader BSM figure — was valued at roughly \$8.9 billion globally in 2025, and the Middle East & Africa region accounted for about 4.9% of that, or approximately \$0.44 billion, rising to about \$0.49 billion in 2026. ([Fortune Business Insights](#)) That's the entire region — Middle East and Africa combined — not Nigeria alone.

This doesn't make the opportunity small for a single company. A few hundred mid-market and large construction and property-development firms paying ₦200,000–₦1.2 million a month is a genuinely good business. But the number that should anchor the plan is bottoms-up: the count of Nigerian construction and property-development firms spending ₦20 million or more a month on materials, times a realistic penetration rate — not a slice of a global category total. Build that number before the pilot ends. It's the number a board or an investor will actually ask for, and the original plan doesn't have one.

Who else is already here

The original document positions this as close to open ground. It isn't quite:

- **SeamlessProcure** already markets approval workflows, supplier management, spend analytics and ERP integration to businesses in Nigeria, Ghana and Kenya — close to the same feature list as Procurely Flow's MVP. ([SeamlessProcure](#))
- **Fraxion** is positioned specifically for SMEs in retail and construction, with budget control and multi-level approval workflows. ([Nigeria procurement software roundup](#))
- **Duplo**, a well-funded Nigerian B2B fintech, has expanded from payments into what it now calls a unified spend-management platform — approvals, vendor payments, expense management — for SMEs and mid-market companies. ([Duplo](#)) In 2026 it secured two licenses from the tax authority specifically to support the e-invoicing rollout described below. ([TechCabal](#))
- **Vendease** shows the category is fundable at real scale in Nigeria — a \$30 million Series A in 2022. ([AgFunder News](#)) But its model is a food-procurement marketplace that buys, warehouses and finances inventory on its own balance sheet — a capital-intensive merchant model, not the software-plus-optional-sourcing model recommended here. It's a funding comparable, not a product comparable, and a useful

cautionary tale about how expensive the "Procurely-managed fulfilment" tier could get if it isn't kept genuinely optional.

None of this kills the idea. No one above is a construction-native, Nigerian-built RFQ-to-three-way-match workflow tool with an operating sourcing business behind it — that combination is still genuinely Procurely's to take. But the honest pitch is "here's why we win against SeamlessProcure and Duplo," not "there is no competition." Investors and enterprise buyers will find these names within one search of their own; better that Procurely names them first.

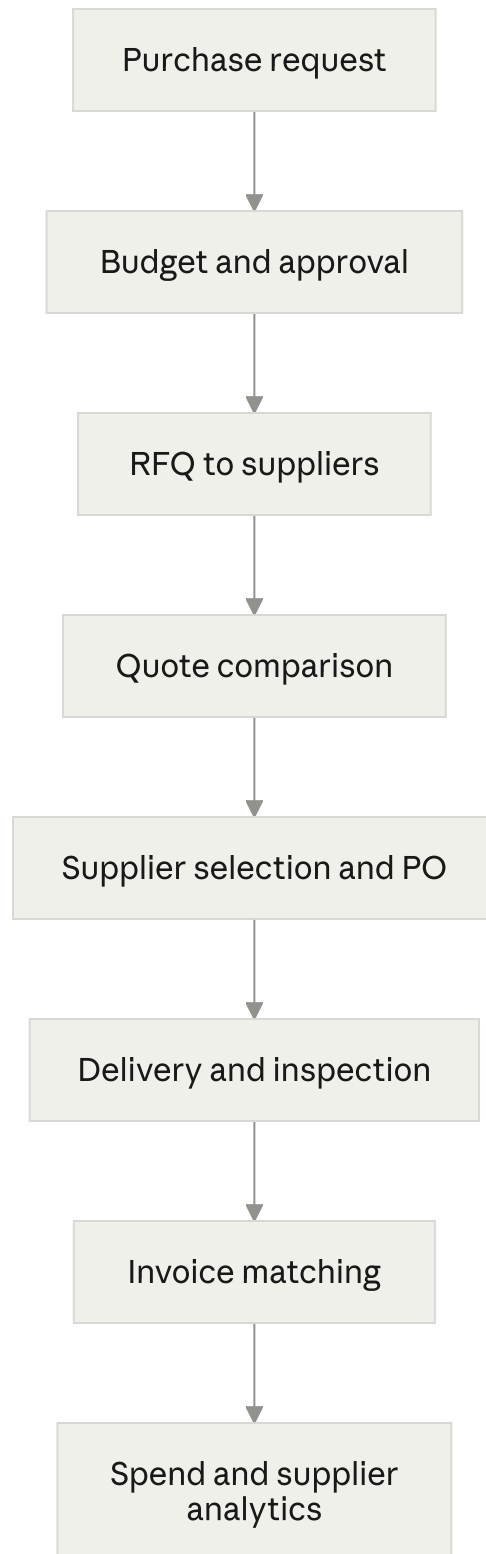
The specific problem it should solve

A site engineer, project manager, administrator or department head needs materials or equipment. Today, the process commonly looks like this:

1. A request is sent through WhatsApp or email.
2. Management asks for several quotations.
3. Procurement contacts multiple suppliers manually.
4. Quotations arrive in different formats.
5. Someone prepares a comparison in Excel.
6. Approvals are delayed or undocumented.
7. Delivery status is difficult to track.
8. Finance struggles to reconcile the request, purchase order, delivery and invoice.
9. Management cannot easily see total spending or supplier performance.

Procurely Flow should put that complete journey into one auditable workflow.

Recommended product workflow



Minimum viable product

The first release should concentrate on the part customers will pay for immediately — see the phased build under *Recommended launch strategy* for what ships when.

1. Purchase requisitions

Employees or project teams can submit requests containing:

- Product or service required
- Quantity and specifications
- Required delivery date
- Project, branch or department
- Estimated budget
- Supporting photographs or documents
- Delivery location

For construction customers, requests should be organised by project and site.

2. Configurable approval workflows

Companies should be able to define approval limits, for example:

- Below ₦500,000: Department Head
- ₦500,000–₦5 million: Department Head and Finance
- Above ₦5 million: Finance and CEO
- Unbudgeted requests: Additional management approval

Approvers should be able to approve from the web platform, email, **and WhatsApp — in the first release, not "eventually."** This is where the behavior you're trying to replace already lives. Deferring WhatsApp support to a later phase means asking approvers to change channels before they've seen any benefit, which is the single most common reason internal tools stall on adoption. Meet them where they already are, then pull them into the fuller platform once the workflow proves itself.

3. Digital RFQ management

The procurement team can convert an approved request into an RFQ and send it to selected suppliers.

Suppliers should not need a paid account. They should receive a secure link through which they can enter:

- Unit prices
- VAT
- Delivery charge
- Delivery timeline
- Payment terms
- Quotation validity
- Warranty

- Supporting quotation

4. Automated quotation comparison

This should be one of the platform's signature features.

The system should generate a side-by-side bid analysis showing:

- Lowest price per item
- Total landed cost
- Delivery timelines
- Credit terms
- Supplier rating
- Historical performance
- Compliance status
- Recommended award

The platform may highlight the best commercial option, but the buyer should make the final selection.

5. Purchase orders

Once approved, the system generates a branded purchase order with:

- Unique PO number
- Supplier and buyer information
- Item description and pricing
- Payment terms
- Delivery details
- Approval history
- Applicable taxes
- Digital acknowledgement

Build multi-currency line items in from day one. A meaningful share of construction materials and equipment — steel, generators, specialised plant — is priced in dollars even when the deal ultimately settles in naira. Retrofitting currency support later means re-touching every screen that displays a price, including the comparison engine and the analytics dashboard.

6. Delivery and inspection

The receiving team should record:

- Items delivered
- Quantity accepted or rejected

- Photographs
- Delivery note
- Date and time
- Receiving officer
- Quality observations

For project sites, the platform should work well on mobile phones and under poor network conditions.

7. Invoice and three-way matching — with a live compliance deadline attached

The system should compare:

- Purchase order
- Goods received or service confirmation
- Supplier invoice

Any difference in quantity, price or tax should be flagged before payment. Three-way matching is a standard control used to reduce payment errors and improve audit readiness. ([Ivalua](#))

Treat this module differently from the rest of the MVP, because the ground shifted under it in 2026. Nigeria's tax authority — the Nigeria Revenue Service (NRS), the renamed Federal Inland Revenue Service — has moved from proposing e-invoicing to enforcing it. Large taxpayers (turnover above ₦5 billion) went live in August 2025, and the NRS's enforcement deadline for full compliance was **July 31, 2026**. Medium taxpayers (₦1-5 billion turnover) became mandatory this same month, with enforcement following in January 2027; smaller taxpayers follow from July 2027. Invoices that aren't cleared through the government platform — the Merchant Buyer Solution (MBS) — can no longer be used to reclaim VAT input credit. ([Nairametrics](#), [VATupdate](#))

Your recommended initial segment — property developers and construction firms spending ₦20m-₦500m a month on materials — will mostly fall inside the medium-to-large taxpayer bands now facing this deadline. That changes the calculus: this isn't a compliance module to bolt on in year two, it's a live, budget-approved pain point for exactly the companies you want as customers right now.

You don't need to become a licensed NRS integration point yourselves — Duplo already did that work. But the invoice data model in your three-way-matching module should be built to the MBS structured format from day one: invoices under the mandate are structured XML or JSON conforming to the UBL/PEPPOL BIS 3.0 schema, carrying a unique Invoice Reference Number and digital clearance stamp, and a PDF (even a signed one) doesn't qualify. ([Duplo](#)) Modelling your invoice fields to that schema now means that connecting — directly or through a partner like Duplo — is a configuration change later, not a rebuild.

"We'll get your purchase-to-invoice trail compliant with the new NRS rules" may be a stronger door-opener for your first ten customers than the RFQ pitch on its own.

8. Management dashboard

Management should see:

- Total spend
- Spending by project, department and category
- Requests awaiting approval
- Outstanding purchase orders
- Delivery delays
- Savings against initial quotations or budgets
- Supplier concentration
- Supplier delivery and quality scores
- Credit utilised and outstanding
- Procurement turnaround time

One compliance note that applies across all eight modules: this platform will handle personal data — employee names tied to approvals, supplier contacts, banking details for payment. The Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023 and its regulator, the Nigeria Data Protection Commission (NDPC), are actively enforcing registration and annual compliance-audit filings in 2026. Build with data-minimisation and access controls in mind from the start; retrofitting privacy controls into a live product with enterprise customers is far more expensive than designing for it up front.

Procurely's differentiation

Procurely Flow should not compete as another generic ERP, and it shouldn't claim to be uncontested either. Against the named players above, its positioning should be:

Procurement software combined with access to an active sourcing and fulfilment network — something SeamlessProcure, Fraxion and generic ERPs don't have, and something Duplo and Vendease approach from a different angle (payments and inventory financing, respectively, not workflow-plus-sourcing).

A customer can choose either:

- **Self-managed procurement:** The customer uses the software and its own suppliers.
- **Procurely-assisted sourcing:** Procurely sources quotations and negotiates the purchase.
- **Procurely-managed fulfilment:** Procurely handles sourcing, supply, delivery and documentation.

This hybrid model is more defensible than software alone, against generic competitors, precisely because it's grounded in a real operating business rather than a marketplace built from scratch.

Capability	Generic accounting software	Procurement marketplace	Procurely Flow
Internal purchase requests	Limited	No	Yes
Approval workflows	Limited	No	Yes
Competitive RFQs	Limited	Yes	Yes
Quote comparison	Usually no	Sometimes	Yes
Purchase orders	Sometimes	Sometimes	Yes
Delivery verification	Limited	Sometimes	Yes
Invoice matching	Limited	No	Yes
NRS e-invoicing readiness	Varies	No	Yes
Procurely sourcing service	No	Limited	Yes
Local supplier intelligence	No	Sometimes	Yes
Procurement credit	No	Sometimes	Later

Best initial customers

Do not start by targeting every Nigerian business. Start with organisations that purchase frequently, have multiple approvers and suffer materially when goods arrive late.

The best initial segment is:

Property developers and medium-sized construction companies spending approximately ₦20 million to ₦500 million monthly on materials, equipment and project supplies.

After proving the product there, expand into:

- Facilities-management companies

- Hotels and hospitality groups
- Schools and healthcare organisations
- Retail chains
- Manufacturing companies
- Multi-branch corporate organisations

Construction is an especially strong entry point because its procurement involves multiple sites, volatile material prices, many suppliers and strict project timelines. Modern construction-procurement systems accordingly emphasise supplier comparison, project controls, material tracking and accounts-payable integration. ([Trimble Materials](#), [Tradogram](#))

Monetisation model

The subscription structure below is directionally sound. Two things the original plan didn't decide, and should:

Currency exposure. Procurely's costs — cloud hosting, and likely some tooling — are dollar-denominated. Revenue, as priced, is naira-denominated. The naira currently trades around ₦1,360 to the dollar officially and ₦1,410–1,425 on the parallel market, and has moved substantially in short windows before. At today's rate, the tiers below convert to roughly \$55, \$147, \$367 and \$880 a month — genuinely reasonable B2B SaaS pricing in dollar terms, not aggressive. The open question isn't whether the price is too high in absolute terms; it's (a) whether it reads as affordable against a Nigerian customer's naira cash flow rather than a dollar benchmark, which needs field validation, and (b) how you protect margin if the naira moves another 20–30% against dollar-denominated costs. Pick a deliberate approach — naira pricing with a stated quarterly or biannual review, or a USD peg converted at billing time — rather than defaulting to fixed naira pricing and re-deciding under pressure later.

How the bill actually gets paid. Don't assume Western-style auto-renewing card billing. Recurring, especially dollar-denominated, card charges have a well-documented failure rate in Nigeria because of central-bank restrictions on foreign spend through naira cards, and even domestic recurring card billing is less reliable here than invoice-and-transfer collection. The standard pattern for Nigerian B2B software is closer to what Duplo itself offers its own customers: generate an invoice, collect by bank transfer or a dedicated virtual account number, reconcile automatically. Design billing around that from the start rather than discovering it after churn from failed renewals shows up in the data.

SaaS subscription

Plan	Suggested monthly price	Target customer
Starter	₦75,000	Small organisation, one branch/project
Growth	₦200,000	Growing company with multiple approvers
Business	₦500,000	Multiple projects, sites or entities
Enterprise	Custom, from ₦1.2m	Large organisations requiring integrations and support

Annual payment could attract a 10-15% discount. Treat these figures as a starting hypothesis to test during the pilot, not a settled price list — see *what to validate* below.

Additional revenue

- One-time onboarding and process configuration
- ERP or accounting integrations
- Supplier verification fees
- Managed-sourcing fees
- Fulfilment margins on purchases handled by Procurely
- Premium spend analytics
- Supplier-sponsored visibility, with clear separation from award decisions
- Procurement financing or early-payment income through a licensed financial partner

Credit should come later and should be funded or underwritten through a regulated financial institution. Procurely should not carry uncontrolled credit exposure while still proving the software — Vendease's capital-intensive model above is the cautionary example.

Adoption is a people problem before it's a software problem

The original plan doesn't name this risk: digitising procurement removes discretion from whoever currently manages supplier relationships informally, and in construction and property development, that discretion sometimes has value to the person holding it — a preferred supplier relationship, a side arrangement, simple control over who gets asked for a quote. This isn't a Nigeria-specific claim; it's one of the most well-documented reasons procurement-digitisation projects stall anywhere, because the person you need to adopt the tool is sometimes the person with the least personal incentive to make every purchase auditable.

Two practical implications: pick a pilot sponsor with real authority to mandate use, not just enthusiasm for the idea, and design the RFQ and comparison views so they make the buyer

look good for finding savings — rather than only exposing who they used to buy from and why.

What not to build first

Avoid starting with:

- A broad Amazon-style supplier marketplace
- A complete ERP
- Inventory and warehouse management
- Payroll or accounting
- AI supplier negotiations
- A full NRS e-invoicing gateway built in-house (partner or integrate instead — see Module 7)
- Logistics fleet management
- Embedded lending with Procurely's own funds

These could make the project expensive before you have validated the primary workflow.

The real product moat

The software itself can eventually be copied. Procurely's stronger moat will be the accumulated data and operational network:

- Verified supplier records
- Historical material prices
- Actual delivery performance
- Supplier reliability scores
- Project procurement benchmarks
- Negotiated payment and credit terms
- Category-specific buying patterns
- Geographic availability of products
- Real transaction outcomes

Over time, this can support a **Procurely Price Intelligence Engine** that tells a buyer whether a quotation is reasonable based on product, location, quantity and recent purchases. That moat depends on the historical pricing and supplier data Procurely already holds being structured, not scattered across spreadsheets, emails and WhatsApp threads — worth a deliberate data-cleanup pass now, since it's foundational to a feature you're planning to build the long-term story around.

Recommended launch strategy

Use Edala — or another willing development customer — as the design partner, with a named pilot sponsor who has real authority to make the tool mandatory for site teams, not just enthusiasm for it. Split the pilot into two build phases so the timeline matches what's actually shippable:

Phase 1 (weeks 1-10, roughly the original 8-12 week pilot window): Purchase requisitions, configurable approvals across web, email and WhatsApp, RFQ distribution, quote comparison, PO generation with multi-currency line items. This is the core loop that replaces WhatsApp-and-spreadsheet chaos, and it's realistic to pilot in this window.

Phase 2 (following the pilot): Delivery and inspection capture, three-way invoice matching built to the MBS structured format, and the management dashboard. These depend on Phase 1 data existing first, and inspection/matching workflows need real field-testing on a live site before they're trustworthy. The full eight-module MVP is realistically a 6-9 month build for a small team, even scoped this way — plan and communicate the timeline accordingly rather than implying all eight modules ship inside the pilot.

Establish a baseline in week one — today's actual average approval time, RFQ turnaround, and documentation completeness — before the pilot starts. Then the original success measures hold:

- At least 80% of purchase requests initiated on the platform
- Approval time reduced by at least 40% against the measured baseline
- RFQ comparison produced within hours rather than days
- Complete documentation for at least 90% of purchases
- Measurable savings or cost avoidance
- Reduced delivery delays
- Management able to view project spend without requesting a new spreadsheet

Only after this pilot should you invest in the fuller supplier portal, integrations and mobile applications.

What to validate before committing real budget

- **Build cost and timeline.** Get an actual estimate from whoever will build this, scoped against the phased plan above, before setting expectations with Procurely's leadership or any outside investor.
- **Willingness to pay beyond Edala.** Run the pricing tiers past five to ten prospects outside Procurely's existing relationships. An existing client with an existing relationship isn't a clean pricing signal.
- **The e-invoicing wedge.** Decide now whether Procurely wants to work through a licensed NRS integration partner (like Duplo) or stay entirely out of the transmission

layer and just get the data model right. This affects the Phase 2 build.

- **A bottoms-up market number.** Count the Nigerian construction and property-development firms that plausibly fit the ₦20m–₦500m/month segment, and use that — not the global BSM figure — in any pitch.

My final recommendation

Build **Procurely Flow: a procurement workflow, sourcing and spend-control SaaS for project-based African businesses**, beginning with construction and property development. The idea clears the bar — it's grounded in a real operating business and a real customer, which most first-time SaaS plans aren't.

The first marketable promise should be:

Control every purchase — from request and approval to supplier selection, delivery and invoice — all in one place, and stay ahead of the NRS e-invoicing deadline while you're at it.

What separates a good outcome from a wasted year isn't the product idea, which is sound. It's treating the real market size, the named competition, the e-invoicing deadline and the internal adoption risk as inputs to the plan now — not as details to discover later.